

Employee Expense Reimbursement Policy

1. Purpose and Scope

This Expense Reimbursement Policy governs the submission, review, and approval of all employee business expenses. It applies to all permanent and contract employees who incur expenses on behalf of the company during the course of their duties. The company is committed to reimbursing legitimate business expenses promptly and fairly while ensuring responsible use of company funds. All employees are expected to act honestly and in accordance with this policy when submitting expense claims.

2. Expense Categories and Approval Thresholds

All expense claims are classified by category. Each category has an auto-approval limit and a hard maximum. Claims within the auto-approval limit are approved automatically provided all other conditions are met. Claims between the auto-approval limit and the hard maximum require manager approval. Claims exceeding the hard maximum are rejected and will not be reimbursed.

Meals and Subsistence: Auto-approved up to 25 GBP per claim. Claims between 25 GBP and 50 GBP require manager approval. Claims exceeding 50 GBP are rejected.

Travel and Transportation: Auto-approved up to 100 GBP per claim. Claims between 100 GBP and 200 GBP require manager approval. Claims exceeding 200 GBP are rejected.

Equipment and Hardware: Auto-approved up to 200 GBP per claim. Claims between 200 GBP and 500 GBP require manager approval. Claims exceeding 500 GBP are rejected.

Entertainment and Client Events: Auto-approved up to 50 GBP per claim. Claims between 50 GBP and 100 GBP require manager approval. Claims exceeding 100 GBP are rejected.

Office Supplies and Stationery: Auto-approved up to 50 GBP per claim. Claims between 50 GBP and 100 GBP require manager approval. Claims exceeding 100 GBP are rejected.

Other Business Expenses: Auto-approved up to 50 GBP per claim. Claims between 50 GBP and 150 GBP require manager approval. Claims exceeding 150 GBP are rejected.

3. Receipt Requirements and OCR Validation

A receipt or proof of purchase must be submitted for all claims exceeding 25 GBP. Receipts must clearly show the vendor name, transaction date, and total amount paid. Digital receipts and photographs of physical receipts are accepted provided the image is legible and complete. The automated OCR system will extract and verify key fields from uploaded receipts. If the OCR-extracted amount differs from the submitted amount by more than 20 percent, the claim will be flagged for manual review. An overall OCR confidence score below 0.40 indicates an unreadable receipt and the claim will be rejected. Confidence between 0.40 and 0.70 will result in escalation for manual receipt inspection by a manager.

4. Duplicate Claim Detection

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The system automatically checks each new expense claim against previous submissions within a 7-day window. Any claim from the same employee with a similar amount (within 10 percent) and the same vendor submitted within 7 days will be flagged as a potential duplicate and rejected. Employees must contact their manager directly if they have a legitimate reason to submit what appears to be a duplicate claim. Intentional duplicate submission will be treated as a disciplinary matter.

5. Monthly Spending Limits

Each employee has a monthly spending limit per category set at three times the hard maximum for that category. When cumulative approved expenses for a category in a calendar month reach 80 percent of the monthly limit, subsequent claims in that category are automatically escalated to the manager for review regardless of the individual claim amount. Employees approaching their monthly limit will be notified by the HR system so they can plan spending accordingly.

6. Non-Reimbursable Expenses

The following types of expenses are not eligible for reimbursement under any circumstances: personal items unrelated to business duties, alcoholic beverages unless explicitly pre-approved as part of a client entertainment event, traffic fines and penalties, personal travel or holiday costs, and expenses for spouses or family members unless pre-approved in writing for a specific business purpose. Expenses that fall outside the approved categories must be pre-approved by the employee's manager and HR before they are incurred.